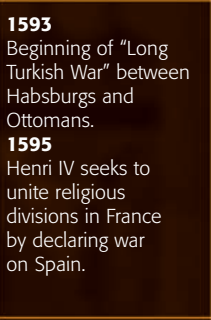
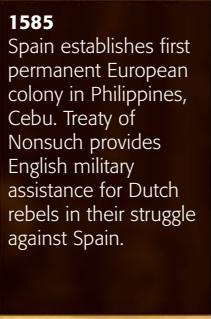
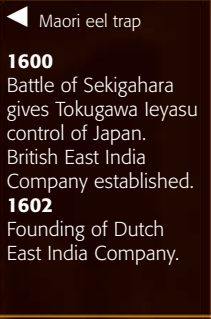


Europe after 1450 benefited from a scientific as much as a philosophical revolution. The Renaissance was more than a matter of the rediscovery of the continent's ancient learning—it sparked a spirit of scientific inquiry that provided key technological advantages over the rest of the world. It was as much a desire for knowledge for its own sake, as for commerce and

colonization, that underpinned the voyages of exploration that established mid-18th century Europe as the world's first global power. This expansion was made in the face of formidable opposition. At least until 1700, Ming, later Qing, China; Mughal India; and Safavid Persia were Europe's equals, while Ottoman Turkey presented a persistent threat.

1530	1550	1570	1590
 1534 Henry VIII of England breaks with Rome. Ottoman–Safavid war; Ottoman capture of Baghdad. Jacques Cartier explores Strait of Belle Isle and St. Lawrence. ◀ Henry VIII	 1550 Suleyman mosque begun in Istanbul. 1552 Henri II of France assists the German protestants in overturning authority of Charles V in Germany. Sultan Suleyman ▶	 1571 Battle of Lepanto: Ottoman expansion in Mediterranean halted. Portuguese invasion of Zambezi. 1576 Mughal forces capture Bengal in north India. ▼ Battle of Lepanto	 c. 1590 Maori population rise causes strain on resources; warfare increases. 1592 Japan invades Korea; Repulsed by Chinese troops and Korean navy. ◀ <i>Mariner's Mirror</i> c. 1590
 ▲ Gold Inca armbands 1536 Wales and England formally united under Act of Union. Henry VIII begins dissolution of monasteries in England; crushes Catholic rebellion.	 1555 Charles V concedes "Accord of Augsburg," giving German princes freedom to select protestant or Catholic religion. 1556 Mughal Emperor Akbar begins personal rule.	 c. 1570 Flemish cartographer Mercator presents new world-map projection. 1570 Portugal founds colony in Angola; starts slave trading. ▼ Mercator map	 1593 Beginning of "Long Turkish War" between Habsburgs and Ottomans. 1595 Henri IV seeks to unite religious divisions in France by declaring war on Spain. ◀ Maori eel trap
1532 Francisco Pizarro lands in Peru and encounters, captures, and kills Inca emperor Atahualpa. 1533 Pizarro conquers Inca capital, Cuzco. ▼ Silver censer	 ▲ Elizabeth I 1565 Beginning of Ivan IV's "reign of terror" in Russia. Spain claims Philippines. South American Indian population decimated by European diseases.	 1585 Spain establishes first permanent European colony in Philippines, Cebu. Treaty of Nonsuch provides English military assistance for Dutch rebels in their struggle against Spain. 1590 Peace treaty negotiated between Safavid Persia and Ottomans. Toyotomi Hideyoshi achieves unification of Japan: capital moved to Edo (modern Tokyo). ▼ Japanese tea ceremony	1600 Battle of Sekigahara gives Tokugawa Ieyasu control of Japan. British East India Company established. 1602 Founding of Dutch East India Company.
	 1558 Elizabeth I becomes Queen of England. Akbar conquers region of Gwalior in central India. England loses Calais, last French possession. Smallpox in Americas ▶	1586 Japan begins reunification. 1588 Accession of Shah Abbas to throne of Safavid Persia rolls back Ottoman territorial gains. Spanish Armada fails to conquer England.	